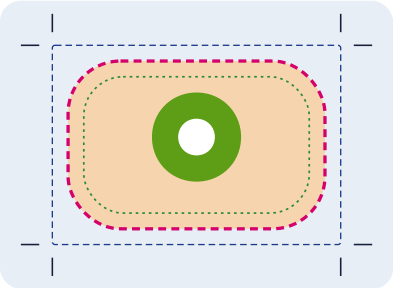
עברית

PEERPRINT · Offset Department

Print-Ready File Instructions for Offset Printing



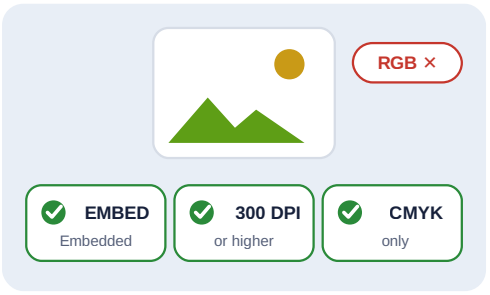
We receive PDF files finalised to print quality, so please pay attention to a number of points. Go through the 11 points, watch the short animation beside each one, and tick it off when you are done. When everything is ticked, your file is ready to send.

Images, colours and bleed

What to send and how to prepare the background

1 Images: Embed, 300 DPI, CMYK

Images must be set to **EMBED** (embedded in the file, not linked), and you must make sure they are at a resolution of **300 DPI** or higher, in **CMYK** only.



Embedded image, 300 DPI or higher, in CMYK

Please note: files created in artificial intelligence (AI) apps, and in programs such as Corel and Canva, are not compatible with Adobe PDF. They cause problems in preparing the file for production, so avoid them.

Why CMYK and not RGB?

- **Printing works in CMYK.** If we have to convert an image from RGB to CMYK on our side, the colours in the final result may change, and not always in the direction you expected.
- **A linked image may disappear.** A linked file that was not sent with you will not appear in the print. Embedding keeps everything inside the file.
- **300 DPI or higher.** At a lower resolution the image will print blurry.

☐ I have finished this step

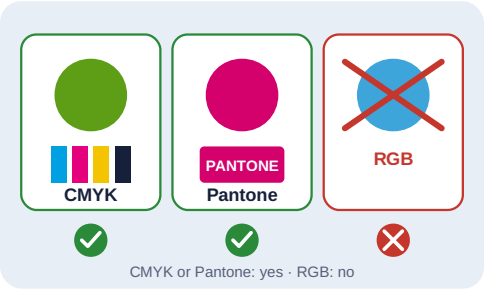
2 Vector elements: CMYK or the required Pantone

For vector elements, such as logos and illustrations, make sure the colour is defined in **CMYK** or in the **required Pantone**.

If an exact Pantone shade is required, define it as a Pantone in the file, not as an RGB shade.

Please note: a vector element left in RGB will be converted to CMYK on our side, and the colour in the final result may change.

☐ I have finished this step



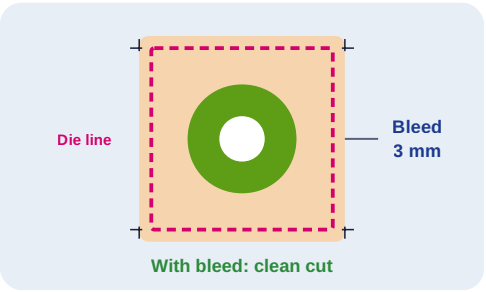
Vector colour: CMYK or Pantone

3 3 mm bleed

Add about **3 mm** of bleed on every side. If there is a die line, add **3 mm** on every side **relative to the die line**.

The bleed area continues the artwork that appears inside the net. This prevents visible problems after cutting, for example a white edge.

☐ I have finished this step



The pink line is the die line; the colour continues 3 mm beyond it

Die cut and finishes Spot colours, overprint and cut marks

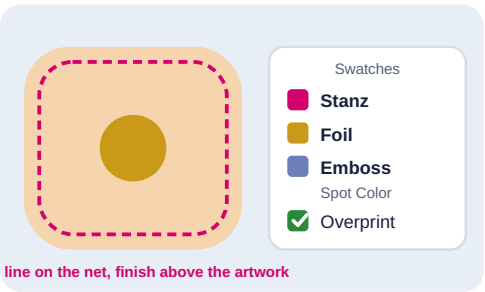
4 Die cut and finishes: spot colour in overprint

Finishes, such as **die cut, foil, emboss, spot varnish, scratch-off** and so on, must be marked as an **additional spot colour (SPOT)**, given a logical name that describes its function, and set to **overprint**.

For example: **Stanz** or **Diecut** for the die cut, **Foil** for foil, **Emboss** for emboss. Each finish gets its own spot colour.

Place the die line above the artwork. **The die line marks the net**, meaning the final size, not the gross size (the artwork together with the bleed).

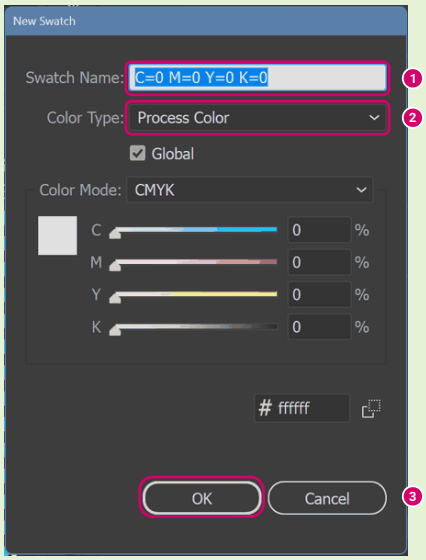
Overprint controls: `Window ▸ Attributes`



Every finish is a separate named spot colour, in overprint

How to create a named spot colour in Illustrator

1. Open the Swatches panel: `Window ▸ Swatches`.
2. Click **New Swatch** (the button at the bottom of the panel, or in the panel menu).
3. In the **Swatch Name** field (marker 1 in the picture) type the name, for example **Stanz**.
4. In **Color Type** (marker 2), instead of Process Color, choose **Spot Color**, and confirm with **OK** (marker 3). The colour value itself is not important, and the new colour will appear in the swatch list.
5. Select the object (the die line) and click the new colour in the list to apply it.
6. In the **Attributes** panel, tick overprint.



Why is overprint needed?

By default, an object placed over artwork "cuts out" the artwork in production (knockout): in the area it occupies, whatever is underneath is removed and not printed. With overprint the object is added on top of what is underneath, and nothing is deleted.

That is why the die line and the finishes (Foil, Emboss, spot varnish) are defined as spot colours set to overprint: they act as separate layers above the artwork, and the artwork beneath them stays intact, with no holes and no colour change in those areas.



☐ I have finished this step

5 Check: no white elements in overprint

Check that there are no **white** elements that were set to overprint.

Why does this matter?

An object in overprint is added on top of what is underneath and does not remove it. White is "no ink", so a white element set to overprint simply will not print: it disappears and the colour underneath remains.

To check, select the white elements and open `Window ▸ Attributes`. If **Overprint Fill** or **Overprint Stroke** are ticked, untick them.

☐ I have finished this step

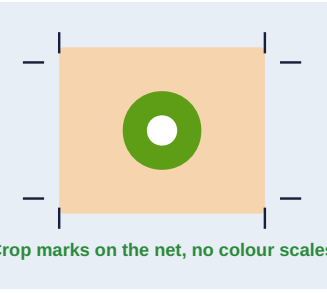


White + overprint = an element that will not print

6 Cut marks on the net

Mark **crop marks** that point to the net. Please **do not** add bleed marks and colour scales.

☐ I have finished this step



Crop marks at the corners of the net only

File structure, text and barcode

Pages, black only and font conversion

7 Booklets: one page per page

Pages for booklets must be sent as a **multi-page PDF**, with each page on its own page, and not as pairs (spreads).

☐ I have finished this step



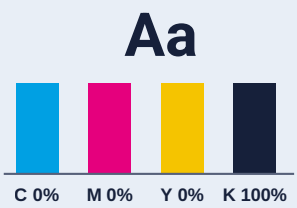
From an attached page pair to separate pages

8 Black text: K only

Black text must be defined as **black only** (C-0%, M-0%, Y-0%, K-100%), without adding any other colours.

Why black only?

Black text made up of several colours is printed on several plates. If the plates are not aligned exactly, the edges of the letters look blurred or coloured, especially in small type. In black only, the text is sharp.



C, M and Y at zero; K at 100%

☐ I have finished this step

9 Barcodes: black only

Barcodes must be coloured **black only** (C-0%, M-0%, Y-0%, K-100%), on a white background or a dark Pantone.

Do not mix more than one colour in a barcode.

Why?

The barcode scanner reads the contrast between the bars and the background. A barcode made up of several colours, or printed on a light background, may not be readable. Bars in a single dark, sharp colour ensure proper scanning.



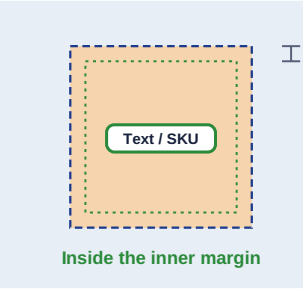
Barcode in one colour, on a light background

☐ I have finished this step

10 Keep important elements away from the cut

Keep important elements, such as **text and SKU codes**, at least **3 mm inside** from the cut.

That way they will not be trimmed even if the cut shifts slightly.



The green frame is the safe area; 3 mm from the cut line

☐ I have finished this step

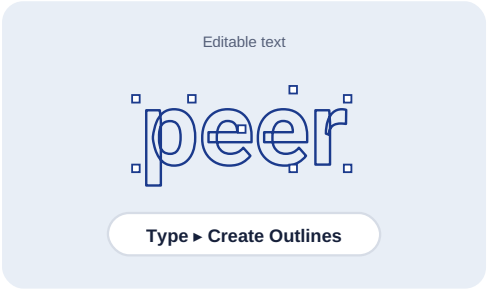
11 Convert text to outlines

Please convert all fonts and text with **OUTLINE \ CONVERT**, that is, turn them into shapes.

In Illustrator: `Type ▸ Create Outlines`

Why convert text to outlines?

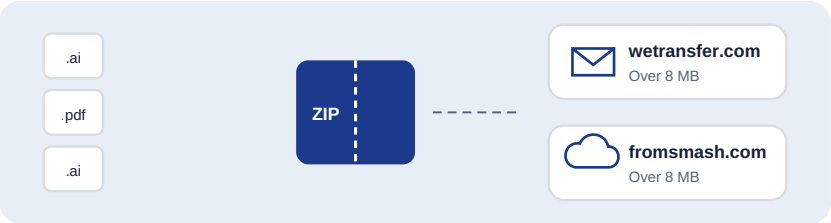
- **The font is not installed on our side.** The file is opened in production on another computer. Text that has not been converted is replaced with another font, and the shape, spacing and line breaks change.
- **Font licensing.** Many font licences restrict passing the font file to a third party. When the text becomes a shape there is no need to send the font at all. Check the licence terms of your font.
- **Keep an editable copy.** After conversion you can no longer edit the text, so also keep the original file on your side.



After conversion the text is a shape, not a font

☐ I have finished this step

Sending the files How and where to send



Large files (over 8 MB)

fromsmash.com Preferred

wormhole.app

wetransfer.com

You can send them using a file transfer service. Prefer the first.

One combined file

ZIP / RAR / 7Z

Please avoid sending individual links shared in the cloud. Combine everything into one ZIP, RAR or 7Z file.

Questions and further details

Contact your account manager.

Please note: do not send Google Drive links. They are not compatible with our work environment.

Deviation from the stated instructions extends the file handling time and/or affects the job pricing.

Interactive web version: peerprint.github.io/roll-sticker-file-guide/offset/en/

Updated version, 19 October 2026.